

Picking Out the Main Points

Skim the text to work out the main points

- 1) You **don't** need to read **all** of a text to find the **main points**.
- 2) Move your eyes **quickly** over the text, looking for **key words**.
- 3) **Key words** are the **most important words** in a piece of text.
- 4) They are words that tell you **who, what, where, when, why and how**.
- 5) **Underline** any key words in a text and use them to find the information you need.

Key words might be specialist words (see p.26).

Not much is known about the origins of Stonehenge. Nobody knows when it was built, but most historians think it must have been between 3000 and 2000 BC.

The main points from the text are underlined. They tell you what the text is about.

Staying inside watching television every day is dull and unhealthy. There are many exciting and healthy outdoor activities that are available in the area, like jogging, sports teams and rowing. Get involved!

The key words tell you that this text is trying to persuade people to do outdoor activities.

The most important point usually comes first

- 1) Each **paragraph** in a text has its **own main point**.
- 2) The **most important point** is usually in the **first paragraph**.

This newly decorated detached house is in a fantastic area on the outskirts of Sanditon. Its location is quiet and rural, but still within easy reach of the town centre.

The property has four bedrooms, a lounge, a fitted kitchen, a dining room and two bathrooms.

The location of the house is the most important point. It's in the first paragraph.

The second paragraph gives extra details.

Practice Questions

Read the text below, and then answer the questions underneath.

Annette Bakes

Search:

Home

Shops

Cakes

Recipes

Awards

FAQs

Contact



Annette Grey
Managing Director

Frequently Asked Questions

How did you get into baking? I've loved baking since I was a child. One of my earliest memories is of adding flour to a cake mixture with the bowl balanced on a stool. I was in my grandmother's kitchen and it went absolutely everywhere! I must have been about five.

How did you turn your hobby into a business? I left school at 17, when I got pregnant, and I didn't really know what to do. I started baking cakes for my daughter's birthday parties. Soon the other mothers were paying me to bake for their kids too. I guess it was an accident, really.

What would you do if you weren't a baker? I always wanted to be in the fire service. I really admire the incredible courage of firefighters.

- Name **one** presentational feature that tells you this is a website.
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- What is the **main** point of this text? Circle your answer.
 - To describe Annette's bakery
 - To tell people how to start a business
 - To tell the reader about Annette's life
 - To convince people to become firefighters
- How did Annette get into baking? Circle your answer.
 - She couldn't be a firefighter
 - Her grandmother ran a bakery
 - She hated school
 - She baked cakes for children's birthdays
- How old was Annette when she left school?
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- Why has Annette always wanted to be in the fire service?
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